

E: Interviewer; K: Participant

0:01-0:17 E: Okay, let me introduce. As we mentioned before, we are interested in your views on romantic relationships. We believe that your experiences will contribute to our project. Before we start, would it be okay if I record this interview?

0:18-0:21 K: Excuse me, can you repeat?

0:21-0:24 E: Before we start, is it okay if I record this interview?

0:25-0:26 K: That's fine. No problem.

0:26-0:27 E: Then let's start.

0:28-0:29 E: How old are you?

0:30-0:31 K: I am [16-20] years old.

0:33-0:35 E: How long have you been with your partner?

0:37-0:38 K: It is almost [6-10] months.

0:39-0:40 E: Do you have children?

0:41-0:42 K: No.

0:42-0:44 E: Who do you live with at home?

0:46-0:49 K: I have my parents and one brother.

0:50-0:51 E: What is your main source of income?

0:52-0:53 K: My father who is a [occupation].

0:59-1:02 E: You are a [occupation], so you don't have a profession at the moment.

1:02-1:06 K: Hihi, of course it is true. I mean, I work part time in a [location] on weekends.

01:06-1:08 E: You work part time. Okay.

01:08-1:09 K: That's right.

1:11-1:15 E: How would you like us to address your partner? Boyfriend, spouse, lover?

1:17-1:18 K: Boyfriend.

1:19-1:21 E: Can you tell me the story of how you met?

1:22-1:41 K: Well, we met on [Social Media] iii I texted him. We had a conversation. Then we met in person. We had a period of getting to know each other for [1-5] month and a half. We became lovers after getting to know each other.

1:43-1:48 E: And how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

1:50-2:07 K: I mean, because it's not that long yet, I mean, the people around me have very long relationships. My friends have relationships of [1-5] years, but despite that, since he is a mature person, I keep up with him and it is going very well for now.

2:09-2:13 E: So iii you are not comparing right now because other people's relationships are very long.

2:13-2:14 K: That is true, yes.

2:16-2:18 E: And how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

2:19-2:20 K: [1-5].

2:21-2:26 E: How would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

2:28-2:39 K: Better. I mean much better. There is a maturity that comes with age. The ones before were very childish, so it's much better now.

2:40-2:42 E: So is there anything else you would like to add?

2:42-2:43 K: No.

2:45-2:48 E: What makes a relationship high quality for you?

2:50-2:56 K: Understanding each other iiiii empathizing and listening to each other.

2:57-2:59 E: So what makes it low quality?

3:01-3:13 K: Disrespect, cheating. Other than that iii it could be not understanding each other, that's it.

3:15-3:22 E: Then for you a strong relationship involves understanding each other, it involves empathy and listening to each other.

3:22-3:23 K: Yes, that's right.

3:23-3:29 E: And in your relationship, for example, how do you know that you understand each other, that you empathize with each other?

3:32-3:53 K: I mean, respecting my ideas and at least commenting on them accordingly. I can see that he can put himself in my shoes from time to time. We also have a lot of discussions about this, but it's not a thing. Somehow, as a result, we realize that we need to talk to understand each other.

3:54-3:59 E: What are the important things in a relationship for you?

4:00-4:02 K: I can't hear your voice, can you repeat?

4:02-4:05 E: What are the important things in a relationship for you?

4:06-4:07 K: Trust, completely trust.

4:10-4:11 E: What else?

4:12-4:17 K: What else. That's all, can't think of

4:17-4:17 E: Okay.

4:19-4:22 K: So iii being able to listen to each other, to understand each other.

4:24-4:28 E: Well, for example, when you say safe, can you explain that a little bit more?

4:29-4:57 K: I mean, for example iii at least I have a little bit of trust problems with myself. Because I was cheated on before because of my previous relationship. So for example, it could be the [Social Media] password. Or at least when he puts the phone when we meet, at least I feel comfortable in this way. Or when he goes somewhere when he gives his news on vacation and so on.

4:57-4:59 E: And what is love according to you?

5:01-5:20 K: I mean, it's a very broad definition, but I think when I feel good. iii I mean when it feels good to me personally. If I feel good around him, if I feel more comfortable, that's love.

5:25-5:27 E: How important is love in a relationship?

5:28-5:32 K: It is very important. I mean, for me, love is what leads to marriage.

5:33-5:35 E: Could you elaborate a little bit more?

5:37-5:50 K: I mean, unless I'm in a marriage of convenience. iii For me, you know, you have to be in love with a person to put up with them. After all, you see them almost every day, every moment.

5:52-5:56 E: iii so how do you know if your partner loves you?

5:56-6:16 K: I mean, from the attention he shows, the time he spares, the way he addresses me, whether he introduces me to his family or not, whether he mentions them or not, whether he brings me into his circle of friends. It depends on where you are in life.

6:18-6:22 E: I see, so what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

6:23-6:40 K: I can't think too much like I'm on my own. As I said, I need to inform him when I am doing something, as I said, I cannot move alone. I am somehow restricted. This is a bit challenging, at times.

6:41-6:43 E: So is there anything else you would like to add?

6:43-6:43 K: No.

6:45-6:48 E: Do you and your boyfriend fight?

6:50-6:50 K: Sometimes.

6:51-6:52 E: How often?

6:54-7:05 K: I mean, we argue like that every [1-5] weeks. But it doesn't come to the level of a fight or a breakup, we argue like this every [1-5] weeks, our ideas don't match, like sulking over something

7:06-7:08 E: And what are these discussions about?

7:10-7:33 K: I mean, when I try to learn his/her ideas for the future or when he/she tries to learn my ideas, when there are opposing opinions, for example, women do this, men do that, then we are already in conflict. Like, will it be like this in the future? We try to change each other.

7:34-7:35 E: And how do you resolve these disputes?

7:37-7:44 K: We try to empathize in the same way by talking to each other again. So even if we can't, we remind each other.

7:47-7:52 E: So what are other ways to maintain your relationship besides empathizing or talking?

7:56-7:58 K: I don't think any other way.

8:00-8:02 E: You can think a little bit more or I can repeat the question.

8:03-8:05 K: Okay, can you ask me again?

8:06-8:14 E: You say that you resolve conflicts by empathizing or, for example, communicating, but what are other ways of maintaining your relationship?

8:15-8:44 K: I mean, for me personally, it might be like giving it some time, at least thinking about it for a few days. But my boyfriend is not like that. He is in the mindset of let's solve it right now, but for me it is. It might be good for me to think about where I am in this relationship at least for a few days. It is good that I think about my relationship, they think for me too.

8:44-8:46 E: So would you say that this relationship is good for you?

8:46-8:50 K: Yes, it's going very well for now.

8:51-8:55 E: So can you explain this a little bit more? Why is it good for you then?

8:55-9:25 K: I mean, I couldn't have a long distance relationship, we are both in [City]. We have the opportunity to meet almost twice, three times a week. Because of that, the feeling of trust in me is more. In other words, it is reinforced more when we are side by side. That's why I feel better when I see that he has no secrets from me. At least I don't have questions in my mind, that way.

9:26-9:28 E: Has this relationship changed you?

9:29-9:30 K: Changed.

9:30-9:32 E: In what way?

9:33-10:00 K: I was more selfish, I was more insecure. At least now I can approach people with a little more trust. I can see that not everyone is the same. Apart from that, my communication with my friends has improved a little bit. I was in a very nervous period. I was in a very tense period, that has improved, you know, in that respect, it also affected my communication with people.

10:00-10:04 E: And did your partner also change during the relationship?

10:07-10:09 K: Changed.

10:10-10:11 E: In what way was he changed?

10:12-10:52 K: Well, he was always a relaxed person or something, but even if he didn't change, he really showed his own identity towards me over time. I can say that in that respect. I understood his behavior towards me due to his own family experiences, for example, his father passed away when he was a [1-5]-year old baby. After I learned these things, I started to forget some of his actions a little more. This is because the concept of father is not present very much.

10:55-10:57 E: Do you feel safe in this relationship?

10:58-11:14 K: I mean, it's not so much to say that in [6-10] months, but it's good for now, I mean, I trust it for now. But I can't say that much, I mean, I can't say anything more for now.

11:58-11:14 E: So now I'm going to show you a question from a scale, but if you can't read it, it's okay, but I'm going to read it anyway.

11:24-11:25 K: Okay.

11:26-11:34 E: My partner usually really listens to me. On a scale of 1 not true at all to 9 completely true, how many points would you give?

11:36-11:36 K: Six.

11:38-11:39 E: I will show you one more.

11:40-11:41 K: iiiii iii iii okay.

11:47 -11:52 E: My partner is usually sensitive to my needs. On a scale of 1 not true at all to 9 completely true, how many points would you give?

11:54-11:55 K: 8.

11:58-12:06 E: The first question I asked, you gave 6 to "My partner usually really listens to me". And why did you give 6?

12:07-12:29 K: So sometimes we sometimes get very stubborn because he thinks that his ideas are too much right. And in that process he never listens to me when I explain to him. It's like our voices get louder when we talk to each other. We talk like this for 10-15 minutes. After that, when I ask him to calm down, he stops talking and starts listening to me.

12:31-12:38 E: So the second question I asked, "My partner is usually sensitive to my needs" you gave an 8. Why did you give 8?

12:39-12:55 K: So he is sensitive, very sensitive. But I can't give a full 9 because he doesn't know how much I need. That's why it's 8, but he is sensitive, very caring.

12:58-13:10 E: I hope you don't mind me asking, and if this is a sensitive subject for you to share, feel free to say so. But we would like to know about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

13:11-13:13 K: We don't.

13:15-13:19 E: Okay. Now I will show one more question from the scale.

13:19-13:19 K: Okay.

13:25-13:31 E: How would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship? -10 completely dissatisfied, 10 completely satisfied.

13:36-13:37 K: So 5.

13:43-13:45 E: 5 So can you explain why you gave 5?

13:49-14:01 K: I mean there are things that we haven't fully established, you know, there are things that we haven't fully established in terms of ideas. That's why I can't say exactly 10, but I'm satisfied, I mean above 0. I wanted to give five, which is exactly between 0 and 10.

14:02-14:04 E: And did your relationship meet your expectations?

14:05-14:07 K: Met.

14:08-14:10 E: Can you explain this a little bit more?

14:11-14:52 K: Sure. I mean, as I already said, I really couldn't be with a person who would say bye-bye if you don't trust. In this regard, you know, he really worked on my insecurities for [1-5] months. He also tried a lot to trust. So I met my expectations in my position, I really didn't expect such a person to be so patient. I mean, it really was like that. At least he respected my thoughts, for example, I said that I didn't want too much sexual intimacy. He respected that, so he didn't say anything.

14:52-14:54 E: I understand.

14:55-15:52 E: We are about to finish now, let me summarize what we talked about. You have been together for [6-10] months. Your romantic relationship started after [1-5] month and a half of dating. Since your relationship is new, you couldn't compare its quality with others. You think it is better than your other relationships. For you, what makes a relationship of high quality involves understanding each other, empathy and listening. The most important things in a relationship are trust and respect for each other. You don't argue with your partner very often, but when you do, you talk it out. You think this relationship is good for you. You think that because you see each other 2-3 times a week, trust is strengthened. You think you changed in this relationship and you think your boyfriend changed too. Is there anything else you would like to add?

16:06-16:07 K: No thanks that's all.

16:08-17:08 E: So now we are done with our study. Since this is a research project, we want to be as transparent as ethically possible. And for this reason I will now ask you which sharing option is the most suitable for you. The first option is to share some parts of the transcript of our interview. None of this transcript will contain any information that can identify you. Thus, your de-identified interview transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a bit bolder, is to share the whole interview transcript anonymized and stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, so that there is a small chance that someone who knows you well will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down the choices among colleagues as to who they believe you to be. Again, I want to emphasize that no sensitive information will be shared. Which one would you choose?

17:08-17:10 K: It can be the second one, I don't mind.

17:11-17:13 E: Done.

17:14-17:16 E: I'm going to stop a recording, the audio recording is over here.